International Institute of Information Technology, Hyderabad
Academic Year 2025-26

Spring 2026 | **CL2.204 Language Typology and Universals** | **Time: 1.5 hrs**
Mid-semester Exam | **Total Marks: 60**

Answer all the questions in the answer booklet

Q1. With respect to sound changes, write short notes on: [3 x 5 = 15 marks]

i. Deletions
ii. Insertions
iii. Assimilation

Q2. For a given language, what are the steps to identify it with a language family? [8 marks]

Q3. Look at the data below and classify them into sets for each language pair separately. Explain the changes that are reflected by naming the sound change in each set. Some words may illustrate more than one change and may be shown in more than one set.

[6+4 = 10 marks]

(A)

Sanskrit	Pali
śaśa	sasa
gāura	gōra
sna:na	sina:na
sneha	sineha
mauna	mōna
keśa	kesa
augha	ōgha
tāila	tēla
dośa	dosa
snihyati	sinihyati
deśa	desa

(B)

Sanskrit	Prakrit
sapta	satta
śara	sara
vismaya	vimhaya
tikta	titta
śava	savva
śakta	satta
karma	kamma
gri:ṣma	grimha
praśna	panha

Q4A. Observe the following data and comment on at least five ways Japanese language makes changes to loanwords from English. [5 marks]

asuterisuku	'asterisk'
nyu:su	'news'
aisukuri:mu	'ice cream'
baiorin	'violin'
baitariti:	'vitality'
koppu	'cup'
hamma:	'hammer'
beruto	'belt'
bitamin	'vitamin'
jampa:	'jumper'
gasorin	'gasoline'

Q4B. Based on these changes, give the English equivalents of the following Japanese words? [5 marks]

i.	burondo	ii.	puragu
iii.	firumu	iv.	sukurin
v.	gureibi:	vi.	re:su
vii.	kurabu	viii.	te:buru
ix.	kareji	x.	risuto

Q5. What is analogical change? Describe briefly analogical levelling and any four kinds of analogical changes with suitable examples. [2+10]

Q6. Give two examples for each of the following: [5 marks]

i. Litotes
ii. Hyperbole
iii. Narrowing (semantic)
iv. Metaphor
v. Synecdoche

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